

*Acanthosaura crucigera***Boulenger's pricklenape lizard**

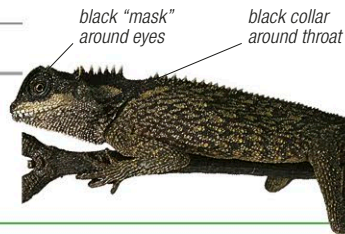
Length 10–12 in
(26–30 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Not evaluated

Location S.E. Asia



Relying on its greenish yellow, cryptic coloring, this lizard often escapes detection from predators by remaining motionless, although

it may open its mouth wide and bite if cornered. It has long, thin limbs, a long tail, a crest of spines on its back, and larger spines on the nape of the neck and over the eyes. The male is larger, more colorful, and has a more pronounced crest than the female. This lizard lies in wait for insects, then suddenly darts out to catch them. Females lay 10–12 eggs at a time in leaf litter or debris.

*Chlamydosaurus kingii***Frilled lizard**

Length 23½–28 in
(60–70 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Least concern

Location S. New Guinea,
N. Australia



Australia is home to a wide range of lizards, but this species is the most spectacular. Its name derives from the large, leathery frill around its neck, which is normally folded back over the animal's shoulders. However, if the lizard is threatened, it opens the frill like an umbrella, and at the same time rocks its body and hisses through its gaping mouth. This display is often enough to deter would-be predators, allowing the frilled lizard to make its escape.

DEFENSIVE BLUFF

This lizard's frill consists of a flap of skin strengthened by rods of cartilage. It is often brightly colored, contrasting with the animal's gray or brown body.

CLIMBING TO SAFETY

Frilled lizards forage mainly on the ground. They are good climbers, and after carrying out their defensive display they usually run up a tree trunk, heading for the highest branches.



orange patches at base of frill

*Hypsilurus spinipes***Southern angle-headed lizard**

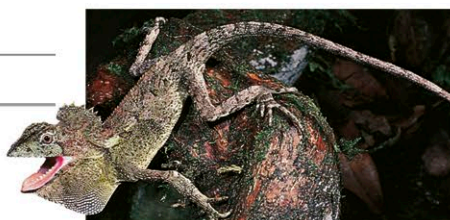
Length 8–13 in
(20–33 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Not evaluated

Location Australia
(S.E. Queensland and
N.E. New South Wales)



This lizard is characterized by a large, angular head, a raised crest (more prominent in males) on the nape and back, and a long

tail. It can "freeze" to avoid detection—a useful tactic against predators such as birds, mammals, and monitor lizards—and its exceptionally long toes and claws enable it to climb trees rapidly to escape from danger on the ground. An active forager, the southern angle-headed lizard lunges quickly and suddenly at insects, its sole food source. The female lays eggs in depressions in soil or in leaf litter.

*Agama agama***Rainbow lizard**

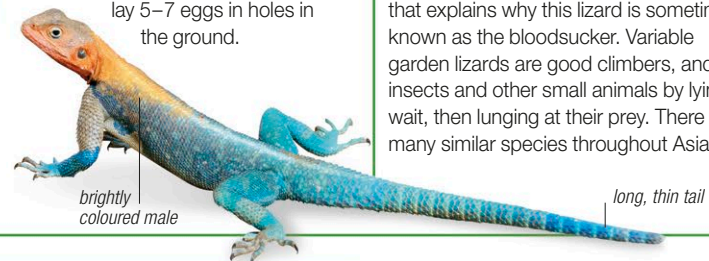
Length 12–16 in
(30–40 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Not evaluated

Location W., C., and
E. Africa



Male rainbow lizards are among Africa's most conspicuous reptiles. At night, they are drab and gray, but when they warm up in the sun, they develop a bright orange head, and a blue or turquoise body.

Females and juveniles are quite different, with a gray coloration that makes good camouflage. Rainbow lizards live in open habitats, and are often seen around buildings. They feed on insects but become omnivorous when food is short. Males have a head-bobbing courtship display, and females lay 5–7 eggs in holes in the ground.



brightly coloured male

long, thin tail

*Draco spilonotus***Flying lizard**

Length 6–8 in
(15–20 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Highly arboreal
Status Not evaluated

Location S.E. Asia



The flying lizard has a pair of "wings," consisting of skin stretched between elongated ribs, which help it glide from one tree trunk to another to avoid predators such as snakes and birds. To take off, the lizard moves its ribs

*Calotes versicolor***Variable garden lizard**

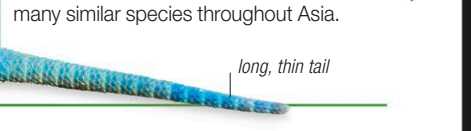
Length 12–14 in
(30–35 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Terrestrial
Status Not evaluated

Location W. Asia to
E. and S.E. Asia



strongly keeled
body scales

This long-tailed lizard is one of the most common species in southern Asia, thriving in farmland and gardens as well as in natural habitats. Its color is highly variable, but breeding males always have a red area around the mouth and throat—a feature that explains why this lizard is sometimes known as the bloodsucker. Variable garden lizards are good climbers, and hunt insects and other small animals by lying in wait, then lunging at their prey. There are many similar species throughout Asia.



outward and opens the flaps of skin, closing them again on landing. It is generally tan or pale brown, with a throat flap for display that is large and bright yellow in the male, but small and pale yellow in the female. Highly agile, this lizard lives on tree trunks and actively hunts for ants. Females only leave the safety of trees to lay 8–12 eggs, which they bury in sand or soil.



"wings" aid
gliding between
tree trunks

*Hydrosaurus pustulatus***Sailfin lizard**

Length 32–39 in
(80–100 cm)
Breeding Oviparous
Habit Arboreal
Status Vulnerable

Location Philippines



As an adult, this large, gray or greenish gray lizard has a well-developed crest of toothlike scales from the nape of the neck down the back. The tail also has a crest, up to 3¼ in

(8 cm) high, which helps the lizard swim. When in danger from predators, mainly birds of prey, this lizard dashes away at great speed, often diving into water to escape. At other times, it may bask on branches that overhang or are near streams. It forages for leaves and fruit, and feeds on insects opportunistically.

